

# GRIFFIN THOMAS

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## SUMMARY

Aerospace engineering student (Aeronautics) at Arizona State University with hands-on design and build experience in unmanned aircraft airframes, subsonic wind tunnel testing, and parametric CAD. Technical interests in aerodynamic control surfaces, airfoil design, and fluid dynamics. Seeking a summer 2027 aerospace engineering internship in design, test, or manufacturing.

## EDUCATION

### B.S.E., Aerospace Engineering (Aeronautics)

Expected May 2030

Arizona State University, Ira A. Fulton Schools of Engineering, Tempe, AZ

Entered with 35 credit hours of AP and dual enrollment credit. Coursework: Calculus I and II, General Chemistry, Digital Circuits, Engineering Design and CAD

### Exeter High School / Seacoast School of Technology, Exeter, NH

May 2026

Completed the four-course Project Lead The Way engineering sequence for dual enrollment credit: Introduction to Engineering Design, Principles of Engineering, Digital Electronics, and Civil Engineering and Architecture

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Design and Modeling:** Autodesk Fusion 360, Autodesk Inventor, AutoCAD

**Fabrication:** FDM 3D printing (Bambu Lab A1), carbon fiber composite assembly, hand and shop tools

**Hardware and Electronics:** RC flight controllers, brushless propulsion, servo-actuated control linkages, digital logic circuits, Raspberry Pi, RTL-SDR

**Software:** Microsoft Office, Adobe Lightroom, Photoshop, Premiere Pro

## PROJECTS

### Modular 3D-Printed UAV Airframe — Independent Design and Build

2025 – Present

- Designed a 59-inch wingspan MQ-9-style unmanned aircraft in Fusion 360 as printed modular sections, allowing field assembly and component-level repair without reprinting the airframe
- Integrated a carbon fiber tail boom, brushless propulsion, servo-actuated control surfaces, and a flight controller
- Revised wing and control surface geometry across print iterations to correct center of gravity and control authority

### Desktop Subsonic Wind Tunnel — Senior Honors Project, Exeter High School

2025 – 2026

- Designed and built a benchtop wind tunnel to observe airflow behavior over airfoil and control surface models
- Sized contraction, test, and diffuser sections for steady flow through the test area and documented results in a written technical report

### ADS-B Aircraft Tracking Ground Station — Independent

2024 – Present

- Built and operate a Raspberry Pi and RTL-SDR receiver decoding 1090 MHz ADS-B transponder data, feeding live aircraft positions to FlightRadar24 (radar T-KBFI187)
- Diagnosed antenna placement and receiver gain limitations reducing usable range, and specified a tuned 1090 MHz antenna as the next upgrade

## WORK EXPERIENCE

### Normandy Park Swim Club, Normandy Park, WA: Lead Lifeguard

2024 – 2026

- Lead guard at a community swim club, responsible for surveillance zone coverage, guard rotations, and emergency response readiness
- Trained and mentored newly certified guards on scanning technique, rescue procedure, and facility operations
- Certified in Lifeguarding, CPR/AED for the Professional Rescuer, and First Aid

## ACTIVITIES

### ASU Air Devils, Design/Build/Fly Aircraft Team: Member

Aug 2026 – Present

**Competitive Swimming** — SMAC Senior Performance, Normandy Park Swim Club, ASU Club Swim Breaststroke specialist (50 and 100); year-round training and championship meet competition

through 2026

**Aviation Photography** — aircraft photography at SEA, BFI, and PHX; submitted to JetPhotos

2023 – Present